

Committee Report



KEY DECISION OR FOR INFORMATION: For Information

COMMITTEE: Transport and Connectivity Committee

DATE: 19 March 2026

TITLE: Workplace Parking Levy Update

Ward(s): Citywide

Officer presenting the report: Adam Crowther **Job title:** Head of City Transport

Committee Chair: Ed Plowden

Executive Director lead: John Smith: Executive Director for Growth & Regeneration

Proposal origin: Committee Chair

Purpose of Report:

To update the committee on progress with the Workplace Parking Levy Outline Business Case (OBC) and to outline progress on key project milestones.

Evidence Base

1. In September 2024, the Transport and Connectivity committee approved up to £1 million for development of a Workplace Parking Levy (WPL) project, including the OBC, and agreed to receive further reports once key milestones are met.
2. A Workplace Parking Levy is proposed as part of Bristol City Council's transport strategy to reduce congestion and generate revenue for transport improvements. It aims to discourage car commuting, promote walking, cycling, and public transport, and improve health, the environment, and land use efficiency.
3. The development of a Workplace Parking Levy scheme involves three key stages; Outline Business Case (2025–2026), Public Consultation and Full Business Case with approval (2026–2027), and Implementation and Operation (2028–2029).
4. The OBC programme is currently in progress, with a planned end date of June 2026.

Stage	Date	Revised date
Supporting studies and information	April to Sept 2025	Complete
Surveys and data collection	October to November 2025	November to early March 2026
Modelling, forecasting and impact assessment	November to January 2026	March to April 2026

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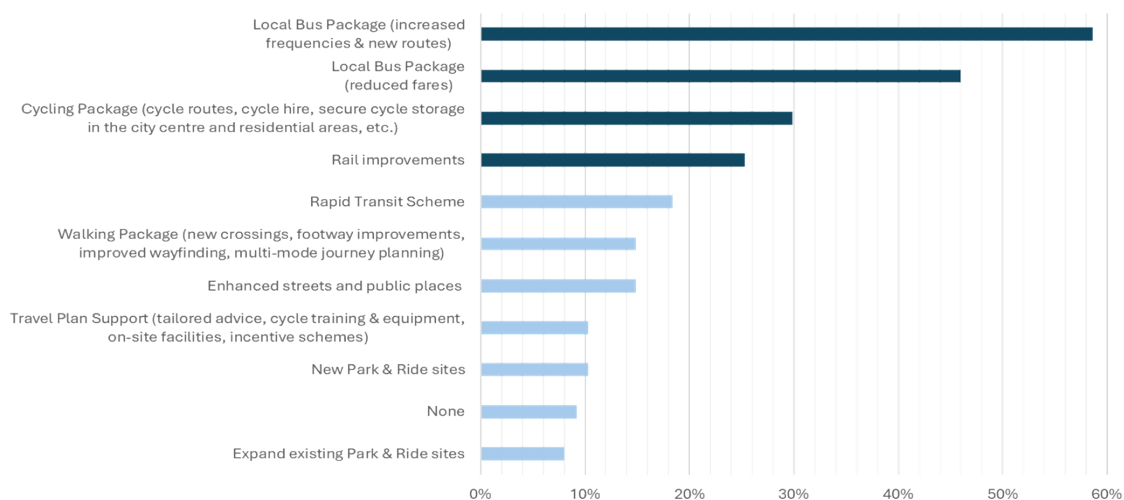
WPL scheme development	November to March 2026	April to May 2026
WPL package and final OBC	January to April 2026	May to June 2026

5. Initial engagement with employer representative groups took place in November and December 2025 via online webinars and meetings. An online parking survey was sent out to workplaces via Bristol City Council, Bristol BID, Business West and Visit Bristol. The survey results will be used to estimate the likely number of Workplace Parking Places (WPPs) in Bristol. Only those organisations that are estimated to have more than five workplace parking places were asked to complete the survey as it is not the intention that smaller businesses would be liable for the WPL if a scheme is taken forward.
6. The programme timeline has been adjusted due to a lower-than-expected response rate to the initial online parking survey. As the survey forms a critical input to the modelling and impact assessment work, it was essential to ensure that the data collected was robust, representative, and sufficiently comprehensive.
7. Following the limited initial response, additional data-collection methods, such as door-knocking, telephone surveys, and targeted off-street parking audits were undertaken to supplement the dataset. While these measures have significantly strengthened the quality and reliability of the information gathered, they required more time to complete than originally planned. As a result, the surveys and data collection stage extended into early March 2026, and the subsequent stages of modelling, scheme development, and OBC preparation were pushed back accordingly.
8. Approximately 570 workplaces have been contacted; this includes schools and colleges across Bristol. Ninety-two responses were received to the online parking survey, which includes some of the city's largest employers such as Bristol University, University Hospitals Bristol and Weston NHS Foundation Trust and The Bristol Port Company. In addition, parking data was collected through door-knocking and telephone surveys for a further 30 businesses. As a follow up to this, off-street parking audits have been undertaken at approximately 200 key employment locations where data was not attained through the other data collection methods.
9. The parking data will feed into the modelling, forecasting, and impact assessment work which is used to predict revenue and assess the likely impacts of a WPL scheme on congestion, air quality, and economic outcomes. A range of options will be tested and further engagement with employer groups will occur at this stage. It should be noted that public consultation is not typically undertaken during the OBC phase so there is no plan for this.
10. Following the results of the modelling, forecasting and impact assessment, a draft scheme will be defined, outlining boundaries, charges, space thresholds, exemptions, and operating hours which will be presented in the final OBC.
11. As part of the OBC, and once a scheme has been defined, it will be possible to set out what is achievable with the estimated WPL funding. The powers to introduce WPL are contained in the Transport Act 2000, which enables local authorities to charge for workplace parking. A WPL is operated through a permit-style licensing scheme where employers are required to obtain a licence for any liable workplace parking places. By law,

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all net revenue raised must be reinvested into improving local transport, after covering operating costs. Any new WPL must also be approved by the Secretary of State before it can be implemented.

12. A high-level Investment Strategy for WPL revenue will be drafted; this will be linked with several workstreams such as the Transport Investment Strategy (TIS) and the Transport Infrastructure Plan (TIP) that are currently being progressed by the City Transport Team.
13. The TIS will set out Bristol's transport revenue streams and guide how this funding can be reinvested to improve transport outcomes. It will provide tools to forecast income, for example, from parking and bus shelter advertising, and assess the value for money of broad investment areas such as public transport, cycling, and maintenance.
14. The TIP will provide the overarching framework for how Bristol prioritises and sequences transport schemes, setting out the city's strategic transport objectives and the improvements needed to support housing growth, economic recovery, and sustainable travel. The TIP summarises and, where necessary, expands on infrastructure improvements outlined across the suite of documents supporting the Bristol Transport Strategy and Joint Local Transport Plan 4. It will guide decisions on which schemes should come forward first by focusing on reliability, reducing congestion, supporting inclusive and affordable travel options, and making best use of limited street space through prioritising walking, cycling and public transport. The TIP will be subject to public consultation and will require committee sign off.
15. The WPL can be positioned as a key mechanism for funding the city's transport priorities. While the TIP provides the overarching framework for major capital investment, WPL revenue can also support the broader transport policy agenda. It could also help unlock match funding from sources such as the Transforming City Regions Fund, increasing the value of local investment and enabling a more ambitious programme of improvements than would otherwise be possible.
16. WPL revenue can also be directed towards priority revenue-funded transport programmes. These may include measures to improve bus services, such as operational support for the existing network, enhancements to the passenger experience, and should future policy development take that direction, work to explore or progress options such as bus franchising or alternative bus service improvement models permitted under current legislation. Funding could also support network management functions and transport behavioural-change initiatives, all of which are essential to improving the performance and reliability of the wider system.
17. To understand business views on how WPL revenue should be invested, the online parking survey included a question on preferred transport improvements. The results show that local bus enhancements are by far the most preferred, with the highest support for increased frequencies and new routes, followed by reduced bus fares. Cycling improvements also score strongly, along with support for rail upgrades.



Alternative options considered:

No alternative options are currently recommended as the approach is in line with advice received from Nottingham City Council who are the only local authority in the country to successfully implement at WPL so far.

When the project comes to committee for approval at subsequent stages of the programme, different options will be presented from the modelling.

Officer Recommendations:

That the Committee for Transport and Connectivity notes this update report.

Corporate Strategy alignment:

- Children and young people** - improved access to transport schemes and initiatives will help ensure all children and young people have a good start in life.
- Economy and skills** – the scheme will help tackle congestion which can have a significant negative impact on economic growth. Revenue from a WPL scheme will help ensure people have improved access to jobs, skills and training.
- Environment and sustainability** – the scheme will help reduce congestion and in turn will work towards BCC carbon and air quality ambitions. It will also contribute to BCC climate and ecological emergencies.
- Healthcare and wellbeing** – the scheme will help tackle health inequalities by providing people with improved access to a range of sustainable transport opportunities such as walking and cycling that will help improve their health and wellbeing.
- Homes and communities** – the scheme can help increase revenue towards transport schemes that can provide more healthy, resilient and inclusive neighbourhoods.
- Transport and connectivity** – a WPL can enable investment in a more reliable, convenient and safer network of public transport and infrastructure for walking and cycling.
- Effective development organisation** – the project aligns with our One City approach of working with our partners to deliver long-term ambitions for the city.

City Benefits:

1. The introduction of a WPL has benefits associated with a reduction in car use and a subsequent increase in the use of alternative modes such as walking, cycling and public transport. In turn this will have a positive impact on people's health.
2. A reduction in car trips into the city centre is likely to result in a reduction in the amount of carbon emissions.
3. A reduction in the number of car trips will have a beneficial impact on air quality.
4. Improved air quality and a reduction in traffic noise will have a beneficial impact on health.
5. A reduction in car-based trips will help reduce congestion and the negative impacts associated with this such as delays and the negative impact this has on economic growth.
6. The greatest potential benefit will be through the transport measures/schemes that can be funded through the revenue raised by a WPL. The revenue should be substantial, predictable and locally generated and will significantly help BCC to develop and deliver transport infrastructure and initiatives in the longer term.
7. The additional revenue generated could fund more sustainable transport options which are particularly beneficial to younger, older people and disabled people who tend to have more limited access to a car and rely more on public transport to access key services such as education and healthcare.

Consultation Details:

1. A WPL is referenced in and consulted on as part of Joint Local Transport Plan 4 and the Bristol Transport Strategy.
2. A Stakeholder Management Strategy and accompanying Communications Plan form part of the OBC stage of the work.
3. A Stakeholder Radar has already been produced as part of the Feasibility Study undertaken by Nottingham CC; this outlines those stakeholders who will be both vital and necessary to engage and consult with as part of the programme. Further information on this is outlined from page 38 onwards of the Feasibility Study (see Appendix A).
5. Formal public consultation is proposed as part of Stage Two of the WPL project if it progresses beyond the OBC stage.
6. Further updates will be brought to the Transport Connectivity Committee as the project progresses.
7. At the end of the Stage One programme, a proposal will be brought back to the Transport and Connectivity Policy Committee for approval and to progress to the next stage.

Background Documents:

1. [Appendix A: Feasibility Study Report for a WPL Scheme in Bristol – Final Draft.](#)
2. [12 September 2024 Transport and Connectivity Committee Workplace Parking Levy report](#)
3. [15 May 2025 Transport and Connectivity Committee Workplace Parking Levy report](#)
4. [23rd October 2025 Transport and Connectivity Policy Committee Workplace Parking Levy Update Report](#)

Revenue Cost	£1 million	Source of Revenue Funding	Clean Air Zone Fund
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Capital Cost	£	Source of Capital Funding	
One off cost ☒ cost ☐	Ongoing	Saving Proposal ☐ OR Income generation proposal ☐	If yes - existing or new saving? N/A

Professional comments section:

1. Finance Advice:

The purpose of this report is to update the committee on progress with the Workplace Parking Levy Outline Business Case (OBC) and to outline progress on key project milestones.

The development of the Workplace Parking Levy (WPL) Outline Business Case (OBC) was approved with a budget of £1 million, funded through the Clean Air Zone Fund. This allocation covers supporting studies, surveys, modelling, scheme development, and stakeholder engagement during the OBC stage. The current expenditure is a one-off cost for the development of the OBC. There are no ongoing costs identified at this stage.

If the Workplace Parking Levy (WPL) scheme proceeds, it is anticipated to provide a consistent and locally generated revenue stream. This funding would be dedicated to improving transport infrastructure and supporting sustainable travel options, helping to deliver long-term objectives for connectivity and climate action. Future capital requirements will be considered during the Full Business Case stage, with potential funding sources such as grants or prudential borrowing.

Finance Business Partner: Vivi Sargioti – Finance Business Partner Growth & Regeneration, 13 January 2026

2. Legal Advice:

As the purpose of this report is to update the committee on progress, there are no legal issues associated with this report or its recommendations at this stage.

Legal Team Leader: Dawn Bodill – Specialist Solicitor – Property, Planning and Transport Team – 5 February 2026 (Team Leader not available).

3. Implications on IT: I can see no implications on IT arising from this report.

IT Team Leader: Alex Simpson – Lead Enterprise Architect – 10 February 2026

4. HR Advice: There are no HR implications evident

HR Partner: Celia Williams, HR Business Partner, 24 February 2026

APPENDICES

Appendix A – Further essential background / detail on the proposal	YES
Appendix B – Equality Impact Assessment (EqIA)	YES
Appendix C – Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)	NO

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Appendix D – Decision Risk Assessment	NO	
Appendix E – Exempt Information	NO	
Appendix F – Details of consultation carried out - internal and external		NO
Appendix G – Options appraisal matrix	NO	
Appendix H – Business case / financial analysis	NO	